



**YEDDYURAPPA
AND BJP
CORPORATORS
CELEBRATE THEIR
WIN IN THE
CITY CORPORATION
POLL**

BANGALORE | The Big Bang

It has taken the BJP 40 years to capture a corporation. But they now are in charge of India's infotech city, sweeping the Bangalore City Corporation polls. "We only dreamed of capturing the corporation and it has become a reality," says Medical Education Minister Ramachandra Gowda, 72, the first Jan Sangh corporator in the city corporation in 1970. He remembers the party's maths: in its former avatar as the Jan Sangh, the party won three seats out of 63. Since then the numbers

have been going up regularly, growing from 25 out of 100 in 1996 to the 2010 victory in which the BJP is in control of 111 of the 198 city corporation seats. The Congress, in power in the previous two terms, trails with 65 seats, with 15 for the JD(s) and seven to Independents. Gowda and Srinivasa Iyengar are the two oldest surviving corporators from the party, which turned from the Jan Sangh into the BJP in 1983. Civic polls for 198 wards of the Greater Bangalore City Corporation were due in November 2006 when the five-year tenure of the then 100-member corporation ended. They were not held until former Congress mayor P.R. Ramesh took the matter to court, which forced the state Government to hold elections last month. Ironically, Ramesh lost the polls in which the BJP campaign was led by Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa. As chief minister, he had promised much to the city: a Rs 18,000-crore, three-year infrastructure project over 800 sq km and a small stretch of the first phase of the Rs 7,000-crore, 40-km Bangalore Metro due to open this December. The promises have paid off.

by Stephen David

